

Puneet Velidi

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EDUCATION

University of Victoria <i>MSc in Statistics (thesis-based, fully-funded), GPA: 4.3/4</i> Co-supervisors: Prof. Farouk Nathoo & Prof. Michelle Miranda Thesis Topic: Bayesian Analysis of Censored Covariates and Neuroimaging Data	Victoria, BC <i>Jan. 2025 – Present</i>
Cornell University <i>BA in Statistics & Economics</i>	Ithaca, NY <i>Sep. 2018 – Dec. 2022</i>

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Graduate Researcher <i>University of Victoria — Department of Mathematics and Statistics</i> Nathoo Lab, PI: Prof. Farouk Nathoo & Prof. Michelle Miranda	Victoria, BC <i>Jan. 2025 – Present</i>
Visiting Researcher <i>University of Birmingham — School of Mathematics</i> AMICO Lab, PI: Prof. Enrico Amico	Birmingham, UK <i>Aug. 2025</i>
Postbac Researcher <i>Harvard Medical School & MGH — Division of Neuropsychiatry and Neuromodulation</i> MGH Photobiomodulation Laboratory, PI: Prof. Paolo Cassano	Boston, MA <i>May. 2024 – Aug. 2024</i>
Undergraduate Researcher <i>Weill Cornell Medicine — Department of Radiology</i> Computational Connectomics Laboratory, PI: Prof. Amy Kuceyeski	Ithaca, NY <i>Jan. 2022 – Dec. 2022</i>

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Software Engineer II <i>Walmart Global Tech — EBS</i> Early Career Recognition, awarded to <10% of 2023 Walmart Global Tech Development Program.	Bentonville, AR <i>Feb. 2023 – May 2024</i>
AI/ML & NextGen Analytics Intern <i>Memorial Sloan Kettering Cancer Center — DigITs</i>	New York, NY <i>June 2022 – Aug. 2022</i>

PUBLICATIONS († INDICATES JOINT FIRST AUTHORSHIP)

Puneet Velidi [†] , Zhengxiao Wei [†] , Shreena N. Kalaria, Yimeng (Flora) Liu, Céline M. Laumont, Brad H. Nelson, Farouk S. Nathoo. <i>Generalized Jeffreys’s Approximate Objective Bayes Factor: Model Selection Consistency, Finite Sample Accuracy, and the Statistical Evidence in 71,126 Clinical Trial Findings</i> . Preprint (submitted for publication). arXiv:2510.10358
Guillermo Gonzalez-Garibay, Puneet Velidi , Akila Weerasekera, Nikos Makris, Carlos Lohmann, Katherine Anne Collins, Naomi Gaggi, Dan Vlad Iosifescu, Paolo Cassano. <i>Cerebellar Volumetric Changes Induced by Transcranial Photobiomodulation Therapy in Major Depressive Disorder: An Exploratory Neuroimaging Study</i> . Submitted for Publication .
S. Parker Singleton [†] , Puneet Velidi [†] , Louisa Schilling, Andrea I. Luppi, Keith Jamison, Linden Parkes, Amy Kuceyeski. <i>Altered structural connectivity and functional brain dynamics in individuals with heavy alcohol use elucidated via network control theory</i> . Biological Psychiatry: Cognitive Neuroscience and Neuroimaging , 2024. DOI: 10.1101/2023.11.27.568762.

PRESENTATIONS

Poster Presentations

Reassessing the Statistical Evidence in Clinical Trials with Extended Approximate Objective Bayes Factors. Maud Menten Institute 2025 HQP Summit and Working Group Meetings. July **2025**; Edmonton, AB.

Photobiomodulation therapy-induced volumetric brain changes on patients with depression. Cognitive Neuroscience Society 2025 Annual Meeting. March **2025**; Boston, MA.

Altered structural connectivity and functional brain dynamics in individuals with heavy alcohol use elucidated via network control theory. Organization for Human Brain Mapping 2024 Annual Meeting. June **2024**; Seoul, SK.

Network control analysis of individuals with substance use disorder. Organization for Human Brain Mapping 2023 Annual Meeting. July **2023**; Montreal, QC.

Oral Presentations

"70,000 Leagues Under the Sea of p-Values," Terry Fox Research Institute PPG, October **2025**

"70,000 Leagues Under the Sea of p-Values," UBC Stats Seminar, October **2025**

"Network Control Theory in Neuroscience: Characterizing the Brain's Energy Landscape," Cognition and Brain Sciences Seminar @ University of Victoria, March **2025**

"Network Control Theory in Neuroscience: Characterizing the Brain's Energy Landscape," UVictoria Maud Menten Institute/Mathematical and Statistical Biology Seminar, February **2025**

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Teaching Assistant

University of Victoria — Department of Mathematics and Statistics

Victoria, BC

Jan. 2025 – April 2025

Math Support Center Tutor

Cornell University — Department of Mathematics

Ithaca, NY

Sep. 2021 – Dec. 2022

SCHOLARSHIPS, AWARDS, RECOGNITIONS

2025	Labs4 — Technology Readiness Level-Up (TRL ⁺) Fellowship Lab-to-market grant; Chimera, CAR-T receptor design for ovarian cancer with deep learning.	<i>15,000 CAD</i>
2025	University of Victoria — FGS Graduate Fellowship (Master's) This fellowship is awarded to students of high academic standing upon recommendation by their department. <i>The typical M&S FGS Master's Fellowship is 2,500 CAD.</i>	<i>4,000 CAD</i>
2025	3MC-PIMS-IDMS-ICMS — Summer School Supported Participant This recognition supported travel expenses + room and board for the 2025 3MC-PIMS-IDMS-ICMS Summer School.	<i>600 CAD</i>
2025	Maud Menten Institute/PIMS — MMI HQP Summit Supported Participant This recognition supported travel expenses + room and board for the 2025 MMI HQP Summit.	<i>350 CAD</i>
2025	Maud Menten Institute/PIMS — Research Accelerator Award This award supports a collaboration with the MGH Photobiomodulation Lab on Bayesian analysis of the TransPhoM-DS clinical trial.	<i>5,000 CAD</i>
2025	University of Victoria — FGS Travel Award & CUPE Conference Award These awards supported expenses for CNS 2025.	<i>1,050 CAD</i>

WORKSHOPS AND SHORT COURSES

3MC-PIMS-IDMS-ICMS Summer School on Quantitative Molecular and Cellular Biology

University of Manitoba, Winnipeg, Manitoba June 16–27, 2025

The summer school aims to equip students with essential tools and methodologies for investigating complex molecular and cellular questions. Courses covered techniques relevant to structural, molecular, and cellular biology, all driven by specific biological questions. Cancer was used as an integrative example throughout the program.

Current as of October 25, 2025

TECHNICAL REPORTS

Immunodynamic Modeling in Melanoma and Gastric Cancer Supervised by Kang-Ling Liao and Michael Chan
3MC-PIMS-IDMS-ICMS Summer School on Quantitative Molecular and Cellular Biology

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

Human Brain Mapping, Reviewer (with Supervisor)

JASA Applications and Case Studies, Reviewer (with Supervisor)